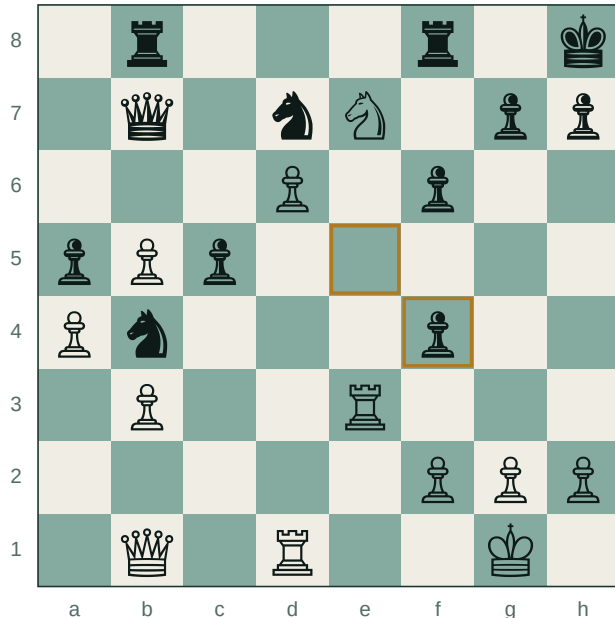


Anastasia mating nets: White, move 26

Anastasia mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 25...exf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Qxh7+ Kxh7 27. Rh3#

26.Qxh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **26...Kxh7**.

27.Rh3# Mate: rook on h3 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The knight is often a supporting piece rather than the final checker. Do not overlook its quiet control of escape squares.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An Anastasia-type net uses a knight to restrict king escapes while a rook or queen checks along an edge file. Removing a pawn shield can be the crucial preparation.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the knight's controlled flight squares and the heavy piece's checking line. Follow how the combination opens that line.

The defending king is on h8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.